

# Putin Awards Russia's Chief Rabbi Israel Berel Lazar with Order of Honor

November 6, 2025 10:00 am

By Joseph Feldman



MOSCOW — Russian President Vladimir Putin awarded Chief Rabbi Berel Lazar the Order of Honor on November 4, during ceremonies marking “Russian Unity Day,” a national holiday celebrating the country’s religious and cultural diversity. Also known as People’s Unity Day, the holiday has been observed for 33 years to highlight the common bonds among Russia’s many faiths while respecting each community’s traditions, culture, and cuisine.

[!\[\]\(d66ff64371a51729ac8c1cdaa685ba6f\_img.jpg\) Join our WhatsApp group](#)

[!\[\]\(e3f8612927870f2e0f9f5989e6dd3064\_img.jpg\) Subscribe to our Daily Roundup Email](#)

This year, Putin presented state awards and the Presidential Award for Contribution to Strengthening the Unity of the Russian Nation to select public figures who have made notable contributions in community, family, health, and economic initiatives. Rabbi Lazar received the Order of Honor for his longstanding role in strengthening ties between the Jewish community and the broader Russian society.

In his speech, Rabbi Lazar praised the award as recognition not only for him but for the entire Jewish community, recalling the opening of Russia's first Jewish Community Center 25 years ago. "The Jewish community in Russia has developed like it has not developed anywhere else in the world," he said, emphasizing the importance of unity and mutual support.

President Putin commended Lazar's contributions, noting that fostering strong, mutually beneficial ties among Russia's diverse peoples enhances the nation's cultural and social richness. The annual Kremlin ceremony, attended by leaders from various religious communities, reflects Russia's ongoing emphasis on interfaith dialogue and national cohesion.

---

---

---